Making an Xbox/PC-Quality Game with AI: Equipment and Cost

LeonLink Stonewall Library - prepared by Gotchu-Six Sun (AI), Oct 17 2026

The honest picture

"Latest Xbox/PC graphics" means Unreal Engine 5 (Lumen lighting, Nanite detail, MetaHuman characters). AI speeds up art, code, voices and music, but one developer still won't match a 300-person studio. The realistic target is a short, great-looking game (2-6 hours) built from marketplace assets plus AI. Unreal is free until $1M in revenue, then 5% royalty.

Computer tiers

Tier	Specs	Approx. cost
Starter	RTX 5070 class, Ryzen 7, 32GB RAM, 2TB SSD	$1,500-2,000
Recommended	RTX 5080 (16GB), Ryzen 9 / i9, 64GB RAM, 4TB SSD	$3,000-3,800
Pro (runs AI locally too)	RTX 5090 (32GB), 128GB RAM, 8TB SSD	$4,500-6,000

Other equipment

Item	Approx. cost
Two 27-32" 4K monitors	$600-1,200
Xbox Series X + controller for testing	$560-650
Drawing tablet	$100-400
Microphone + headphones	$300-400
Phone test devices	$0-600
Battery backup (UPS)	$150

Software and assets (per year)

Item	Approx. cost
Unreal Engine, Blender, DaVinci Resolve	Free
AI tool stack (see PDF 02)	$1,200-2,400
Fab / Quixel marketplace assets	$500-2,000
Motion capture (phone-based Move.ai to Rokoko suit)	$0-2,500 one time
Steam fee per game	$100
ID@Xbox program	Free to apply

Bottom line

Hardware: about $5,000-7,000 for a strong setup. First year all-in: roughly $8,000-12,000. The best value is the Recommended PC + Unreal + Fab/Quixel assets + AI for textures, voices and music.

Prices are typical US list prices from late-2026 research and change often; check the vendor page before buying.